

I Am a Rock

Paul Simon

A winter's day
In a deep and dark December;
I am alone,
Gazing from my window
To the street below
On a freshly fallen silent shroud of snow.
I am a rock.
I am an island.

I've built walls,
A fortress deep and mighty,
That none may penetrate.
I have no need of friendship,
Friendship causes pain.
It's laughter and it's loving I disdain.
I am a rock.
I am an island.

Don't talk of love;
But I've heard the word before;
It's sleeping in my memory.
I won't disturb the slumber of feelings that have died.
If I never loved I never would have cried.
I am a rock.
I am an island.

I have my books
And my poetry to protect me;
I am shielded in my armour,
Hiding in my room,
Safe within my womb.
I touch no one and no one touches me.
I am a rock.
I am an island.

And a rock feels no pain;
And an island never cries.